

Cyber security in the workplace

Item 1 of 9

Cyber security in the workplace

Protecting a company's information, data, assets, knowledge and systems, networks and business continuity, requires putting in effective measures to ensure that digital access is secure.

Cyber security practices can lower the risk of a cyber-attack such as unauthorised access, money extortion or data corruption.

Activity: Watch

The following video shows the anatomy of a cyberattack unfolding

<https://www.cisco.com/c/en/us/products/security/what-is-cybersecurity.html> (04:14)

Write down your key takeaways.

The trainer/assessor will facilitate a discussion about the outcomes from the video.



Image by Icons8 Team on [Unsplash](#)

How much do employees know?

An organisation can have the highest level of security in place, but it will not succeed if workers are not aware of the risks related to cyber security. Promoting workplace cyber security awareness and supporting effective practices can support the success of a business' cyber security strategy.

Activity: Watch

Companies spend millions of dollars every year to protect their private data from cyberattack. However, ordinary people can undermine all their hard work with one mistake - and we often do. Most successful security breaches happen not because of sophisticated attacks, but due to human failures.

Watch this Tedtalk by Mark Burnette: The humanity behind cybersecurity attacks

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pnADP41earI> (18:22)

Write down your key takeaways.

The trainer/assessor will facilitate a discussion about the outcomes from the video.

Cyber security awareness means employees are educated and can:

Recognise security threats

Understand how to avoid security risks

What to do if a security risk arises and how to deal with it

Understand what cyber security risks can do to a company

Protect themselves

Follow compliance regulations and legislation

Use organisational policies and procedures to support cyber security in their job role

Understand their responsibility toward cyber security in their work area

As part of your job role in promoting cyber security the main question to always ask is:

ARE YOU DOING ENOUGH?

Developing awareness, supporting policies, procedures and best practices will be part of helping to ensure that you are doing your best to minimise the cyber threats to the organisation.

However, everyone's job will be different with varying levels of authority and permissions to an organisation's information and data systems. By identifying what employees know and understand about cyber risks and how these can be managed, will be an important step in the levels and consequences of risks that an organisation can face through cyber-attacks.

This must be relevant to roles and responsibilities as well as a holistic understanding of the organisation and industry within which employees work.

To find out what employees know and understand you will need to conduct surveys, interviews, consult and focus on their work activities within their job role so that the cyber security is contextualised and specific to the activities and duties that they are undertaking.

Once you have established what the level of awareness is, then the next step would be to have training and education to support effective cyber security practices.

For example, using a survey to find out information about how a person undertakes their job and the cyber security efforts that they currently use:

How often do you change your password?

Do you access the network from home? What security do you have in place on your computer?

What should you do if you receive an email that includes an embedded link to a 'special deal'?

List three things that you do to protect company data in your job role.

Using an employee's job description and focussing on questions that relate to their work role can provide a clear picture on an employee's level of awareness. For example, someone who manages data entry:

When using the database to enter in client contacts, how can you protect the data once entered?

How are the client records kept private and confidential to other employees?

What information can you give out about the client contacts in the database?

Using a program such as survey monkey or creating a list of questions that can be distributed by hand are two ways of collecting this type of information.

This information can then be used to identify what should be included in the cyber security awareness program. For example, the survey may find that 60% of staff are not changing their password often enough. You can then focus on the training and education to cover this aspect of cyber security awareness.

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Activity: Research

Go to www.surveymonkey.com and check out how the surveys can be developed.

Read about survey design:

[Survey Design 101](#)

The trainer/assessor will facilitate a discussion about the outcomes from the research.

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